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(b) How did Malinowski and Radcliffe-Brown study religion? Elucidate

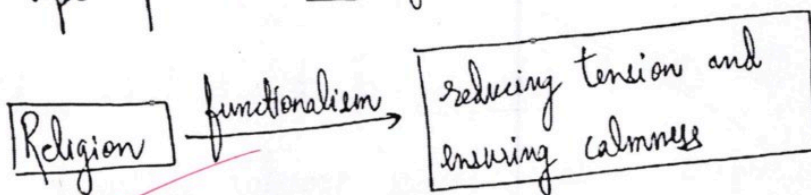
Durkheim in 'The Elementary form of Religion'
defined religion as the sacred and
~~beliefs~~ a unified system and belief in
sacred things.

Malinowski

- 1) did fieldwork among the Trobriand Islanders
(1916-20)
- 2) gave the psycho-functional theory of
religion in his book 'Magic, Science
and Religion'
- 3) He argued that various institutions in
society like religion function to

~~provide~~ fulfill the needs of society.

- 4) He explained that Trobrilander Islanders did ritual and worship in order to cope up with anxiety and stress



- 5) Malinowski following functional theory studied religion

Radcliffe Brown

- 1) Did fieldwork among Andaman Islanders (1906-10) and Australian Aborigine tribe
- 2) ~~have~~ studied religion through the structural-functional approach.

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3) He argued that religion functions so as to maintain the social structure of the society

4) He studied totemism of Arunta tribe and argued various tribes worship different totems ⇒ ensures totems are not ruthlessly killed ⇒ since one totem is food of other clan

↳ hence social structure maintained.

Both were also criticised due to their inability to explain the origin of religion

⑧ Since religion forms the non-material culture, due to paucity of evidence, it's hard to arrive at a conclusion regarding its origin.